

SOP: CUSTOMER RETENTION & CANCELLATION

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Department	Call Center Operations

Applies to: Tier 1 (initial de-escalation + one retention attempt only). Cancellation processing is Tier 3 only — Tier 1 must never process a cancellation.

Steps

Step 1: Open Call & Verify Identity

Precondition	Call connected. Customer likely frustrated.
Action	Deliver greeting, recording notification, and 3-of-5 verification. Complete efficiently — do not let verification feel like an obstacle to a customer who wants to cancel.
Output	Customer verified.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-001, CS-RULE-002, CS-RULE-004

Step 2: Acknowledge Intent Without Resistance

Precondition	Verification complete. Customer has stated intent to cancel.
Action	Acknowledge first — do not argue or immediately mention fees: 'I am sorry to hear you are considering leaving. You have been a valued customer and I would like to understand what has brought you to this point.' Forbidden: opening with ETF information.
Output	Customer acknowledged. Tone de-escalated.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-011, CS-RULE-012

Step 3: Identify Root Cause

Precondition	Customer acknowledged.
Action	Ask one open-ended question: 'Before I transfer you to our specialist team, may I ask what has been the main frustration — is it the service itself, the pricing, or something else?' Map response: Price/Value → retention offer. Service quality → resolve via SOP-03 first, then retention. Competitor offer → match/upgrade offer. Relocation → check service availability at new address before assuming cancellation. Deceased/Hardship → escalate to Tier 3 with empathy, no retention push.
Output	Root cause identified and mapped.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-011

Step 4: Make One Retention Attempt

Precondition	Root cause identified. Not deceased/hardship.
Action	Make one targeted offer based on root cause. Do not make multiple different offers — it undermines credibility. Price: 'Let me check if there are any loyalty bundles available on your account that could bring your bill down significantly.' Competitor: 'You have been with us for [X] years. May I have two minutes to see if we can match their offer or upgrade your speed at no extra cost?' Service quality: resolve issue via SOP-03 first, then ask: 'Now that we have fixed that, does this change how you are feeling about staying with us?' If the customer declines, do not repeat the offer.
Output	One retention attempt made and outcome noted.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-011

Step 5: Warm Transfer to Tier 3 Retention

Precondition	Customer declines retention offer or requests cancellation directly.
Action	Place customer on brief hold (max 2 minutes). Brief Tier 3 agent: root cause, retention offer made and outcome, customer sentiment, account tenure. Introduce: 'I have [Name] from our customer loyalty team on the line. They have the full picture of your account and will take great care of you.'
Output	Customer transferred to Tier 3 with full briefing.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-014

Step 6: Tier 3: Process Cancellation

Precondition	Customer transferred. Tier 3 is now handling.
Action	Calculate ETF: $\$20 \times \text{months remaining}$. Confirm equipment return requirements (non-return fee \$150+). Provide prepaid shipping label if applicable. Confirm final bill date and outstanding balance. Process cancellation in billing system. ETF waivers require Tier 4 authorization — Tier 3 cannot waive ETFs unilaterally.
Output	Cancellation processed, or ETF waiver escalated to Tier 4.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-004, KB-PROD-01 Section 4.2

Step 7: Document & Close

Precondition	Call concluded.
Action	Log case notes within 5 minutes: cancellation reason, retention offer made and outcome, transfer details, ETF and equipment return information if applicable. Provide case reference number. Do not offer post-call survey if cancellation was completed.
Output	Case notes saved. Call closed.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-022

Key Rules

- Cooling-off period customers (within 14 days of contract start) are entitled to a full no-questions-asked refund. Do not use retention offer to delay their request. (FIN-RULE-009)
- Relocation is frequently mishandled as a cancellation. Always check service availability at new address first.

- If customer mentions a competitor's specific price, do not confirm or deny it. Focus only on what NexaLink can offer.
- Abusive customers: apply 3-Strike Protocol before disconnecting. (CS-RULE-016)
- Tier 1 role is de-escalate, uncover root cause, make one attempt. Tier 3 processes the cancellation.